

Reading to learn **How do pictures make us feel?**

1 How do you feel about photography? Choose the option from each pair 1–4 that best expresses your opinion.

1 a Pictures can be very powerful. 3 a We prefer snapshots to serious photography.
b Pictures are always very powerful. b We prefer serious photography to snapshots.

2 a We don't see enough pictures. 4 a Images affect us more due to the media.
b We see too many pictures. b Images affect us less due to the media.

Reading strategy Identifying an author's viewpoint
The author's viewpoint is how he/she presents a topic. When you read an article or essay, try to identify what the author thinks about the topic. Is the author impartial? The author's choice of language and facts can help us to understand this.

2 Study the reading strategy and read the article on page 39. What is the author's viewpoint for the options 1–4 in exercise 1?

3 Read and listen to the article. Answer the questions.

1.10 1 The author mentions the powers of pictures. What are they?
2 What can be "extraordinary" about blockbuster movies? Why can they become "ordinary"?
3 According to the author, how do marketing images affect us?
4 Why does the author think that we don't focus for long on pictures?
5 Why can pictures seem "more stressful than wonderful"?
6 What does the author think of the quality of pictures on social media?

Discover vocabulary Compound adjectives: noun + present participle
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4 Find the adjectives below in the article. Then match each adjective with definitions 1–5.

brehtaking eye-popping heartbreaking mind-numbing never-ending
thought-provoking

1 continue a long time 4 very sad
2 visually stimulating 5 very boring
3 with overpowering impact 6 interesting

5 Rewrite the sentences by creating a compound adjective from the highlighted words.

1 It's a dish that makes my mouth water.
It's a mouth-watering dish.
2 That story warmed my heart.
That story was heart-warming.
3 Those athletes break records.
Those athletes were record-breaking.
4 That kind of shark can eat a man.
That kind of shark was man-eating.

6 TALKING POINTS Discuss the questions.

1 Do you agree with the author's viewpoint? Why? / Why not?
2 Do you think we take too many pictures? Why? / Why not?

Discover more SEARCH ONLINE for thought-provoking pictures in one of the categories below. Choose your favorites, show them to the class, and say why you like them.
advertising portrait press travel wildlife

OVEREXPOSURE
Have pictures lost their magic?

A photograph has the power to transport us to places where we have never been and might never go. Today's armchair travelers can navigate never-ending worlds of amazing images. We have the breathtaking beauty of the universe at our fingertips: from a single virus to a spectacular, distant galaxy; from lost jungle tribes to life in the deepest ocean. We can see images of places, people, and creatures that previous generations couldn't even imagine.

A picture also has the power to reach into our hearts and minds. Photojournalism brings heartbreaking truths to our screens every day: a starving child, a bomb attack, a dying bird. An image can start a campaign or change the course of a war. Finally, the pictures in propaganda and advertising have the power to deceive us and make us buy things. Pictures can manipulate us because we believe what we see more than we believe what we hear. So, photographs have marvelous powers, but are we still under their spell?

Nowadays we see so many pictures that perhaps we don't notice what is extraordinary about them anymore, or we don't care because we've seen it all before. It's like those blockbuster movies. The eye-popping special effects amaze us for the first two minutes, but then they just seem normal. This is what happens when the extraordinary becomes ordinary. We lose our sense of wonder.

Part of the problem is that there are simply so many pictures. Approximately two billion pictures are posted every day. It's a huge number. Recent research suggests that we can feel anxious trying to keep up with all the pictures that we post, view, "like", and comment on. When we are drowning in a flood of pictures, they can become more stressful than wonderful.

Then there's the constant bombardment of images in the news and advertising. It has been estimated that some people see as many as 3,500 marketing messages a day. Interestingly, it has also been found that 99% of those images make little or no impact on us. We are immune to their magic. Pictures have become mind-numbing instead of thought-provoking. Let's be honest – most of the pictures that we see on a daily basis aren't all that wonderful anyway. They are mostly everyday snapshots of people's lives: selfies, cats, families, and friends. Which pictures reach record-breaking numbers of views on picture sharing sites? They are usually of celebrities, usually with their new babies. Nice, but not powerful.

The artist Joan Miró once said "You can look at a picture for a week and never think of it again. You can also look at a picture for a second and think of it all your life." It seems the time has come when we don't remember pictures for over a second. In that second we look, we "like", and we forget. Try to picture in your mind the last image that really impressed you. Can you remember it? I doubt it. The power has gone.

How are images "at our fingertips"?
How can pictures in propaganda and advertising deceive us?
What kind of movie is the author referring to?

Reading to learn

How do pictures make us feel?

Learning objectives

READING Reading an article about photography

READING Identifying an author's viewpoint

VOCABULARY Compound adjectives: noun + present participle

Reporting back

- If students did the *Discover more* activity in the previous lesson for homework, discuss their findings now. See the notes on the previous page.

Introducing the topic

- Ask: *Can looking at a picture change the way you feel? Can pictures make you feel happy or sad? Can they make you feel frightened or angry?* Elicit a few ideas, then ask students individually to think about a picture they have seen which has had an effect on the way they feel. Encourage them to think about pictures they have seen on the news, on social media, etc.
- Put students in small groups to talk about the pictures they thought of, and say what effect they had on them.
- Have a brief class discussion.

1

- Ask students to read the sentences and choose the ones that best express their opinions.

- Put students in pairs to compare their answers and give reasons for them.
- Ask some pairs to tell the class which answers they disagreed about and why.

2

- Ask students to read the reading strategy, or read it aloud to the class. Check they understand *impartial* (= expressing no personal opinion).
- Ask: *Why is it important to identify the author's viewpoint?* Discuss as a class how identifying the author's viewpoint helps you to understand why they are presenting certain facts, and can help you to be more critical and think of other viewpoints when you read.
- Ask students to read the article and identify the reader's viewpoint on the four ideas in exercise 1.
- Check answers, eliciting the part of the article which confirms each viewpoint.

ANSWERS

1 a 2 b 3 a 4 b

3 1.10

- Allow students time to read the questions, then play the audio. Students read and listen to the article and answer the questions.
- Allow students to compare their answers in pairs, then discuss them with the class, eliciting the part of the article which confirms each answer.

ANSWERS

- 1 the power to transport us to other places, the power to reach into our hearts and minds, the power to deceive us and make us buy things, the power to manipulate us

- 2 They can be extraordinary because they show amazing special effects, but they can become ordinary when we see them too often.
- 3 They have very little impact on us.
- 4 Because we see so many of them.
- 5 Because we see so many of them, and we are under pressure to respond by "liking" them or commenting on them on social media.
- 6 He/She thinks they are not very interesting or powerful.

READING TEXT QUESTIONS

- Point to the questions next to the article on page 39. Students read the article again for relevant information and answer the questions.
- Discuss the answers with the class, encouraging students to refer back to the article to explain their answers.
- Ask students if they can think of any examples of advertising pictures which deceive people.

SUGGESTED ANSWERS

Images are at our fingertips because we can see them at any time, with just the click of a button on our phones.

Pictures in advertising and propaganda can persuade us that we need something, or they can make us believe things that are not true.

The author is referring to a blockbuster movie with a lot of special effects, like car chases, fights, etc.

The word "bombardment" suggests that things come toward us as if we are being attacked. The author is suggesting that pictures are not wanted, like an attack. The author involves the reader by using the pronoun "we" and by asking the reader a question.

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- With weaker classes, do the exercise in class before students continue to exercise 4.
- With stronger classes, students can do the exercise for homework.

4

- Ask students to read the definitions. Check they understand them all.
- Students could work in pairs to look at the article again to find the adjectives and match them with the definitions.
- Check answers, and check that students understand all the adjectives. Model pronunciation.

ANSWERS

- 1 neverending 2 eye-popping
3 breathtaking 4 heartbreaking
5 mind-numbing 6 thought-provoking

5

- Read aloud the example answer, then ask students to create compound adjectives and rewrite the sentences. They could work in pairs for this.
- Check answers.

ANSWERS

- 2 That story was heartwarming.
3 Those athletes are record-breaking.
4 That kind of shark is / can be man-eating.

6 Talking points

CRITICAL THINKING

- Allow students time to prepare their answers individually. You could brainstorm a few ideas for each question first, to give students some ideas.
- Put students in small groups to discuss the questions.
- Discuss the questions as a class, encouraging students to join in and add more ideas or their opinions.
- Alternatively, students could write their answers.

Extra activity: Critical thinking

- Ask: *Would social media be possible without pictures? Would you post stories or written accounts of what you're doing if you couldn't upload pictures? Would those stories or accounts be interesting?*
- Have a class discussion and encourage students to imagine social media without pictures and think about why they would or wouldn't continue to add posts or read their friends' posts.

Discover more

- Remind students that they should use the exact search term in the task and a category. Students can do the research in class if they have internet access. Alternatively, they can do it for homework. Ask them to choose their favorite pictures, download copies of them, and make notes on why they like them.
- After the research or at the beginning of the next lesson, put students in groups to show each other their pictures and talk about why they like them.
- Ask groups to look at all the pictures and choose one to present to the class.
- Ask each group to show their picture to the class and explain why they like it. Encourage other students to respond and give their own opinions.

Preview

- Ask students to look at the *Discover grammar* presentation on page 119 before the next lesson.

Further practice

Discover vocabulary Student Book, page 118 (answers on TG page 113)

Workbook, pages 34 to 36

Reading practice worksheet, Teacher's Resource Center